

Bombay Daak, Mumbai

This 'daru and chakna' themed bar from the folks behind Ekaa, feels simultaneously transportive and deeply grounded in drinking traditions across India. Expect a cozy nook with just 30 seats, dark woods, hand-painted tiles and vintage lamps salvaged from a British whisky bar in old Bombay. The hyper-local cocktails by Yathish Bangera pay homage to India's dive bars and include such gems like Finding Fenia, a refreshing cocktail inspired by the Gaud Saraswat Brahmin community's sweet and tangy mango curry and Parangi Malu a gin-based cocktail with smoky flavours of coffee and jackfruit. The chakna menu includes nostalgic favourites such as fried bombil, smoked pork and cheese cherry pineapple, which perfectly complement the cocktails. This is the place to meet friends, toast milestones, complain about your boss or ex, and engage total strangers in conversations.



Must Try
Whistle Podu, a tangy rasam drink spiked with gin, amaro and caramelised tomato packs a punch.

Price
upwards of ₹850 per drink

The Brook, Gurugram

This new bar celebrates underused Himalayan produce. Dive into delightfully nuanced cocktails by Yangdup Lama. The gin-based Duk Ley, meaning "it's beautiful" in Ladakhi, blends sea buckthorn, while the rum-based Mitho Amilo, meaning "sweet and sour" in Nepali, marries the tangy, savoury notes of gundruk with the sweetness of date jaggery syrup. Everyone has a favourite child. Yangdup's is clearly the martini which comes with a hint of Himalayan juniper and a touch of timbur—wild harvested Himalayan Schezwan pepper. The kalari and pankhuri cheeses from Kashmir and Pork Two Ways with dalle chutney make for the perfect accompaniments. The menu also features an intriguing thou cha (tea) programme curated by Anandini Himalaya Tea, alongside freshly roasted coffee by Subko.



Must Try
Happy Himachali Hi Ball with blended whisky, Himalayan apple cider vinegar and maple is a zesty drink.

Price
upwards of ₹725 per drink

